PROPOSAL · OCTOBER 2026

A District Student Advisory Council

Prepared for an October 20, 2026 meeting with SPASD's Directors of Systemic Equity & Inclusion and Strategic Communications

Purpose: make student voice a regular, documented part of how SPASD listens and decides, so it lasts beyond any one student, principal, or superintendent.

What students told us

- **Safety & communication:** after incidents, students rely on rumors and social media.
- **Consistency & accountability:** discipline and follow-up feel different from building to building.
- **Voice & follow-through:** students feel heard symbolically, not systemically.

“Yes I feel safe at school. Yes I would feel comfortable telling an adult. No adults do not listen.” A student, winter 2026 outreach.

Five goals for 2026–27

1. Field the climate survey district-wide and share the results publicly
2. Pilot a District Student Advisory Council with middle and high schools
3. Set regular student–district meetings on a calendar, not by request
4. Back the Student Senate's first action plan, including weighted grades
5. Publish “you said, we did” updates so students see where their input went

The council

	Proposal
Who	Students from all three middle schools, East, West, and PPA, across grades and backgrounds, not the same small group
How often	Regular meetings with district leadership on a set calendar, with agendas and minutes
What	School climate, communication, student experience, and input on policies before they're final
Built to last	A written charter and a staff owner, so it survives any one superintendent or student

From “heard” to “here's what changed”

1. Students raise an issue through the survey, the Senate, clubs, or a council rep
2. The council gathers input from more schools

3. A written proposal goes in: the problem, student input, and a recommendation
4. The district answers in writing: yes, no, or not yet
5. A public update shows what changed, what didn't, and why

Where district offices fit

- **Strategic Communications:** student-facing messages after serious incidents, channels that reach students, a home for “you said, we did” updates, and getting the survey to every family.
- **Systemic Equity & Inclusion:** seats for PPA and underrepresented groups, Spanish-language access from day one, climate and belonging across buildings, and a student-built know-your-rights guide.

Four asks

- Share the survey through district channels
- Name a staff partner for a pilot advisory council
- Put a recurring student–district check-in on the calendar
- Publish one “you said, we did” update this semester

Independent and student-led. Written by Zackary Mark, a high school student in the Sun Prairie Area School District. Not an official SPASD document and does not speak for the district, its staff, or its Board. Shared in good faith; not meant to accuse any person. Contact: zackarymark160@gmail.com · Instagram @spasdstudentvoice